HKOS 101

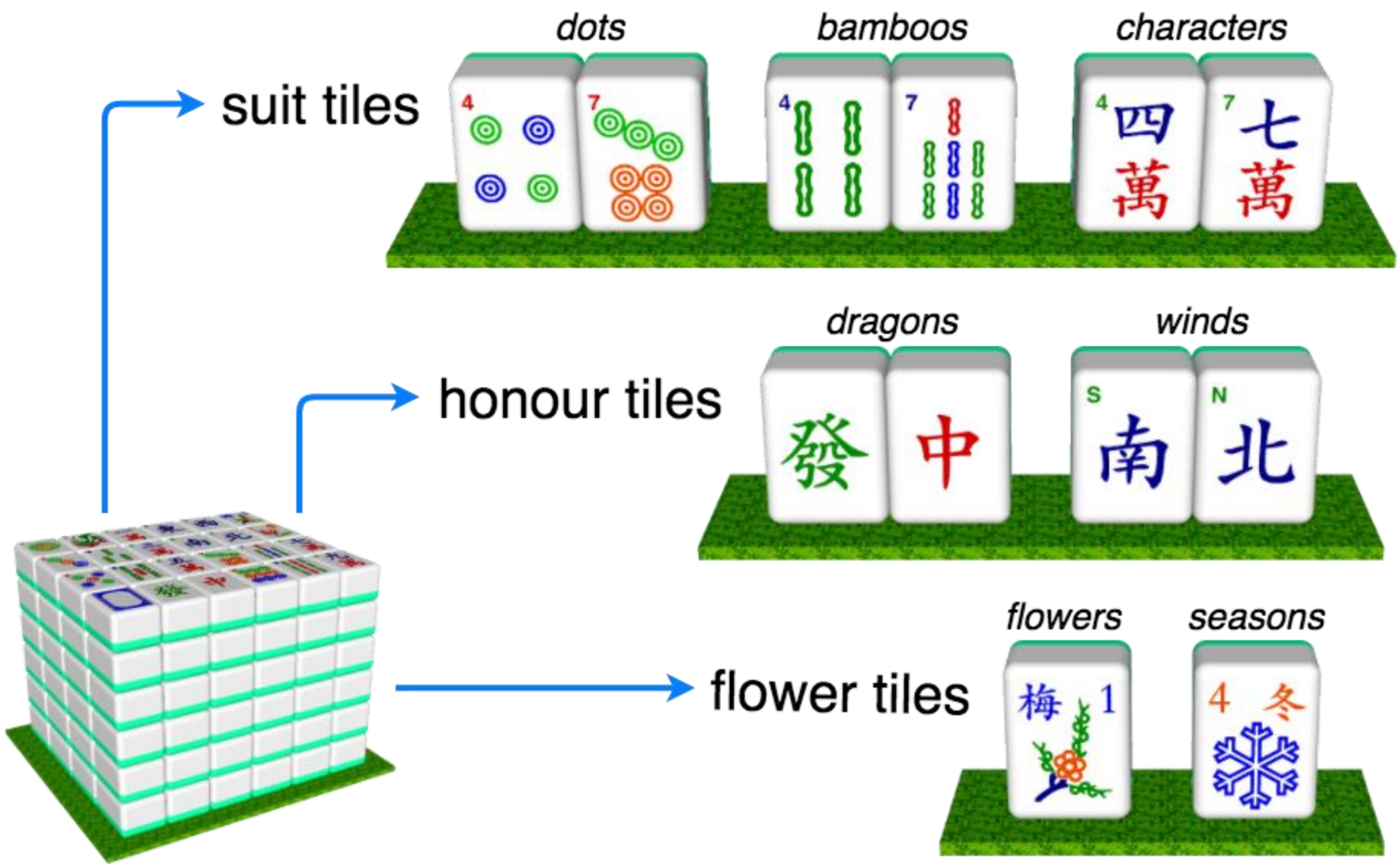
2026-01-22

Why learn mahjong

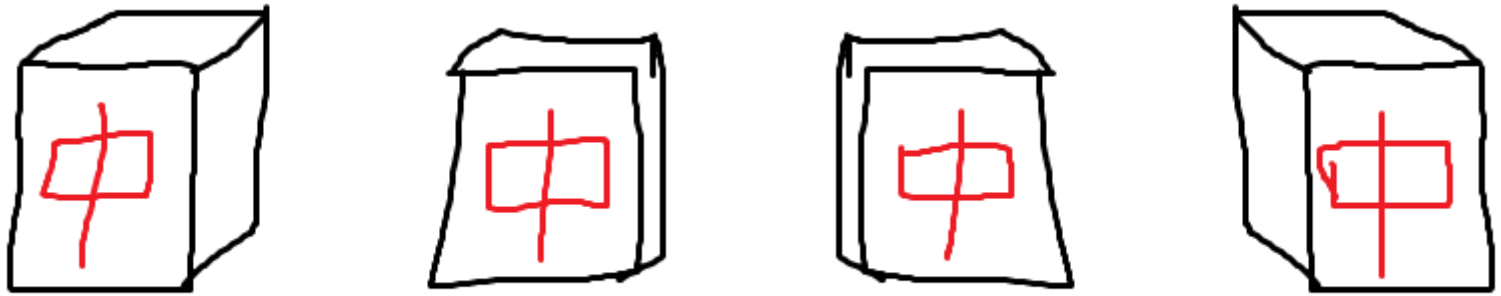
- Connect with your Chinese roots
- Play with your Chinese grandparents
- Heal unresolved trauma from conflict within your Chinese family caused by someone’s addiction to gambling

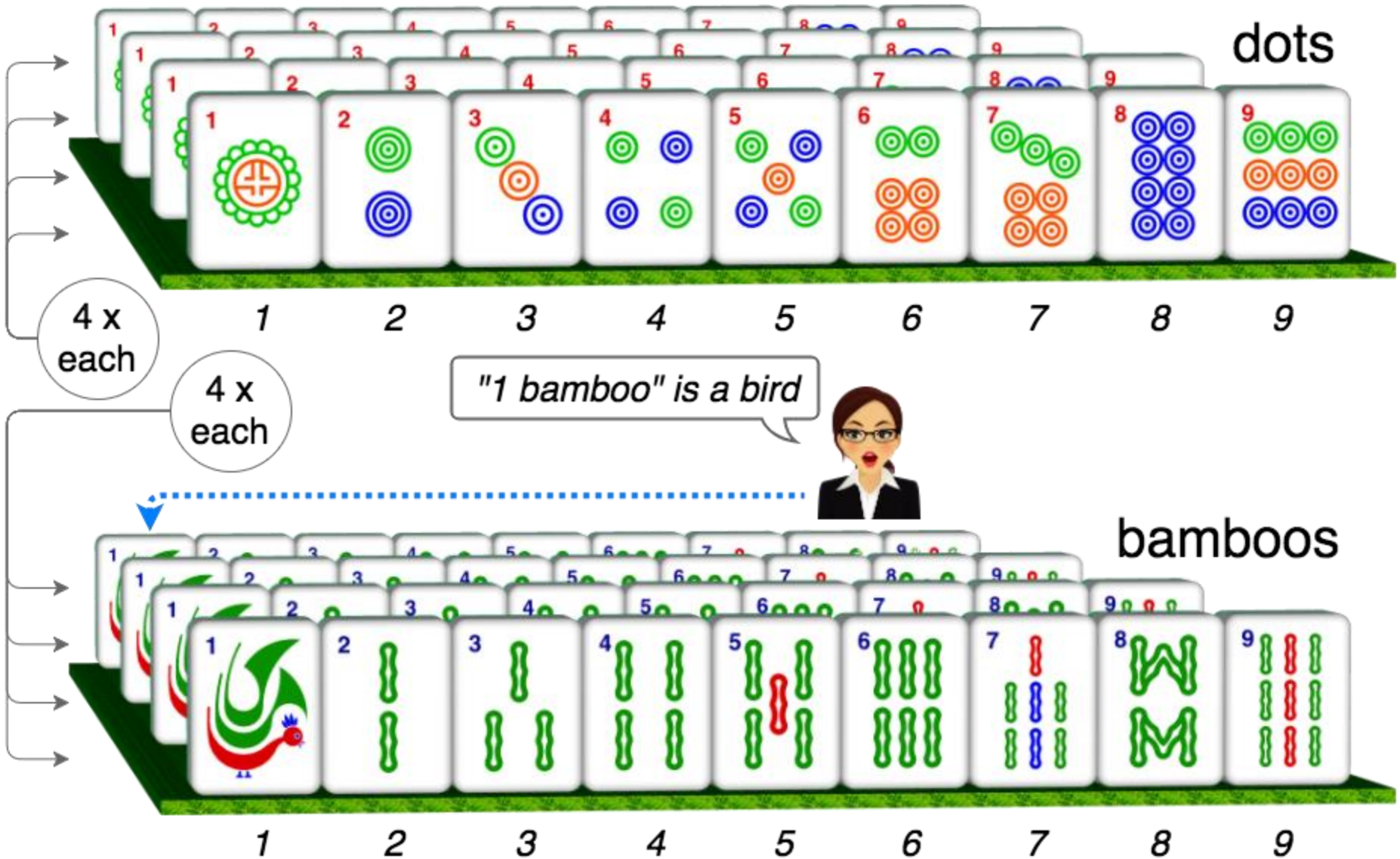
- don’t worry we don’t play with money :)

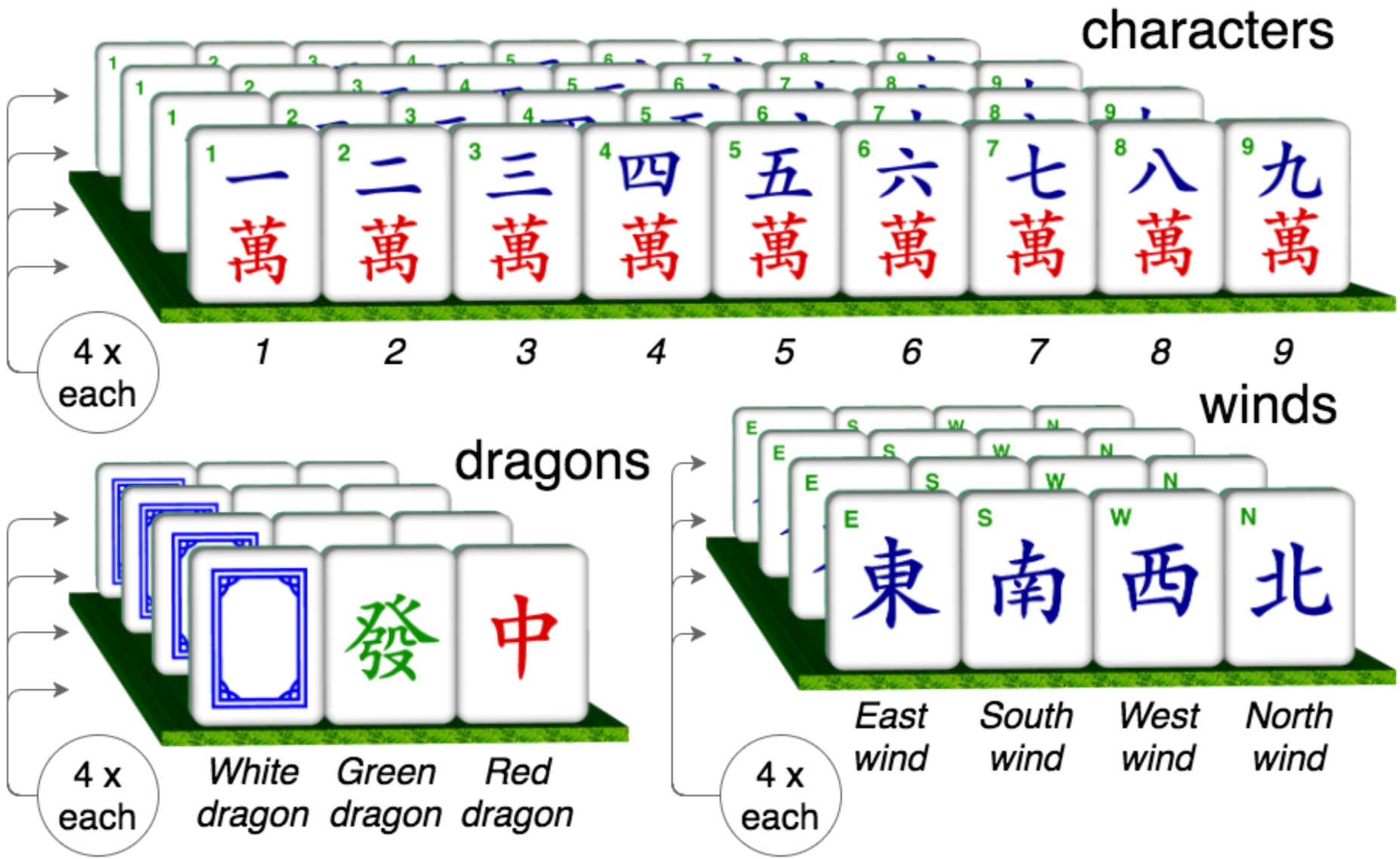
- what tiles are there?


suit tiles
dots
bamboos
characters
honour tiles
dragons
winds
flower tiles
flowers
seasons

- How many copies of each tile ?




dots
4 x each
1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9
4 x each
"1 bamboo" is a bird
bamboos
1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9

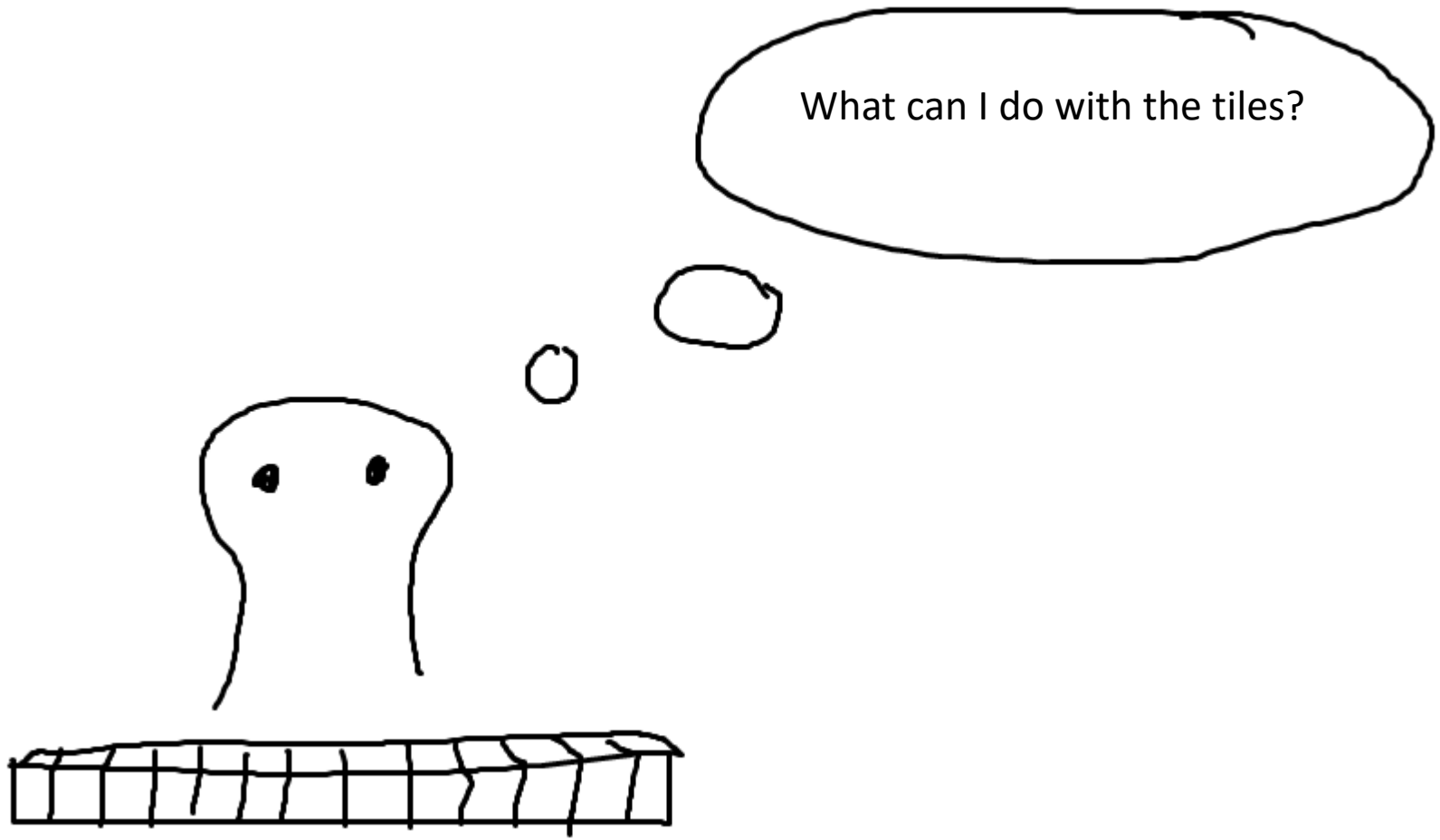

characters
一 萬
二 萬
三 萬
四 萬
五 萬
六 萬
七 萬
八 萬
九 萬
1
2
3
4
5
6
7
8
9
4 x each
dragons
發
中
White dragon
Green dragon
Red dragon
4 x each
winds
東
南
西
北
East wind
South wind
West wind
North wind
4 x each

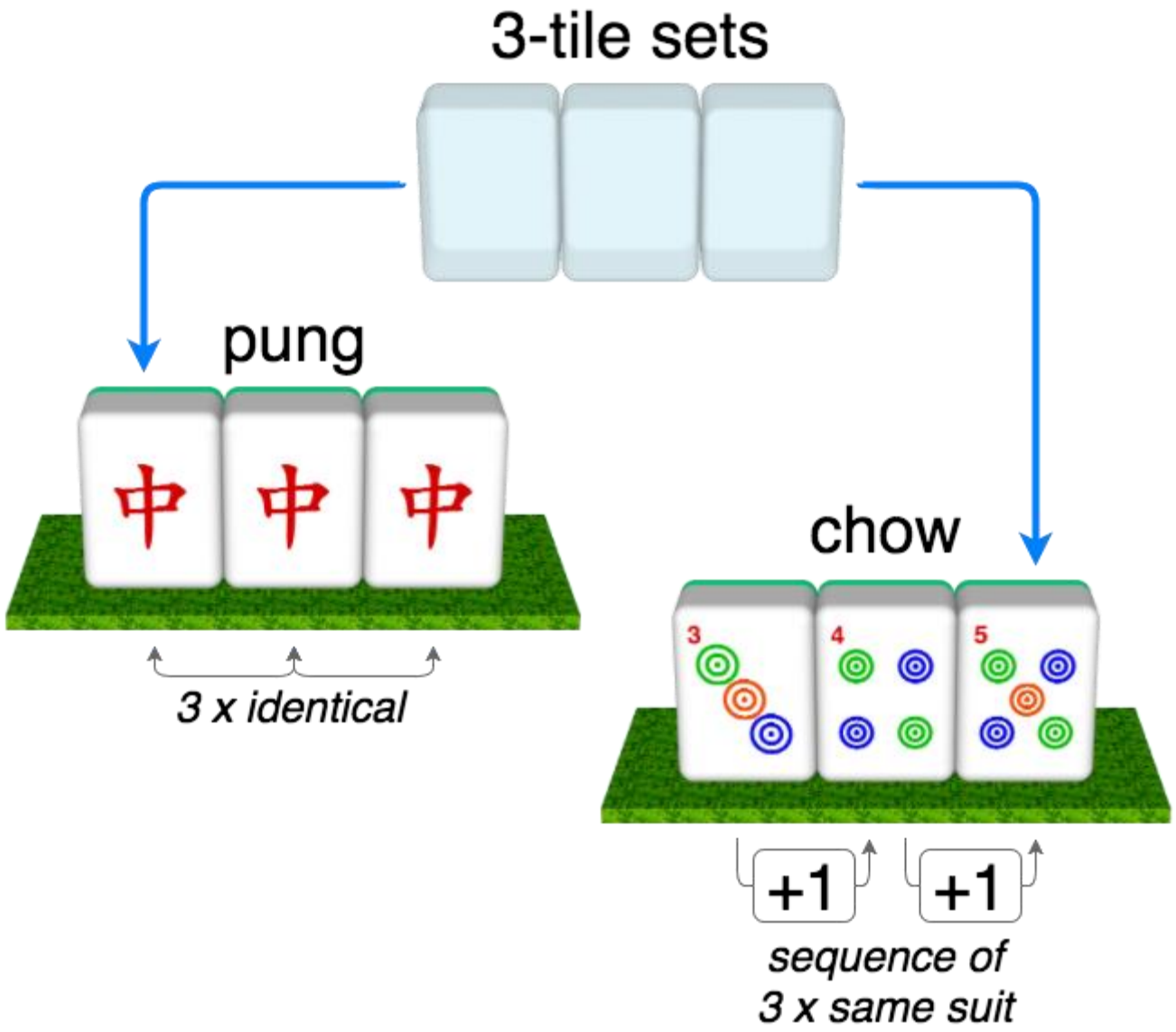
flowers

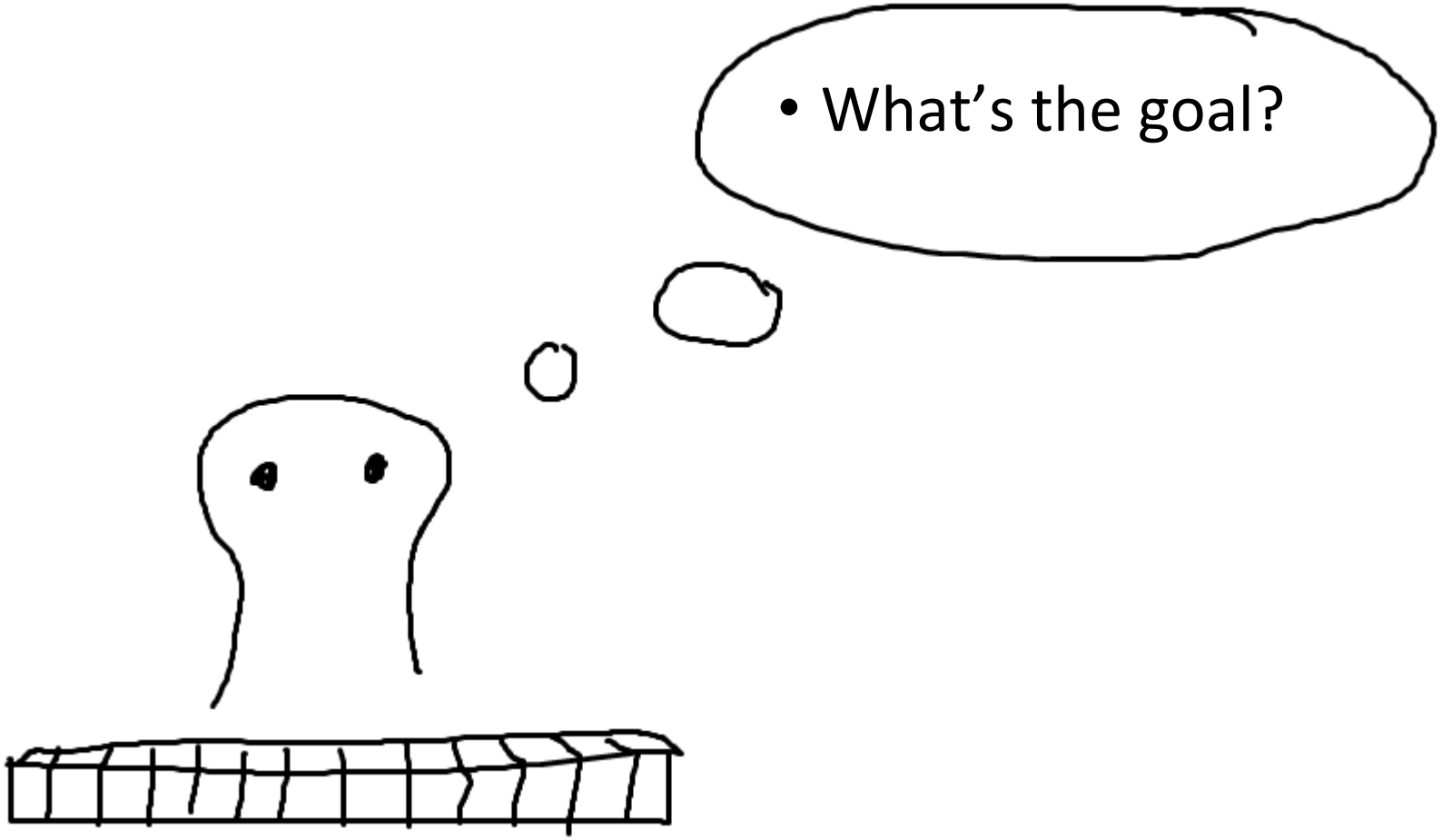
1	2	3	4
plum	*orchid*	*chrysanthemum*	*bamboo*

seasons

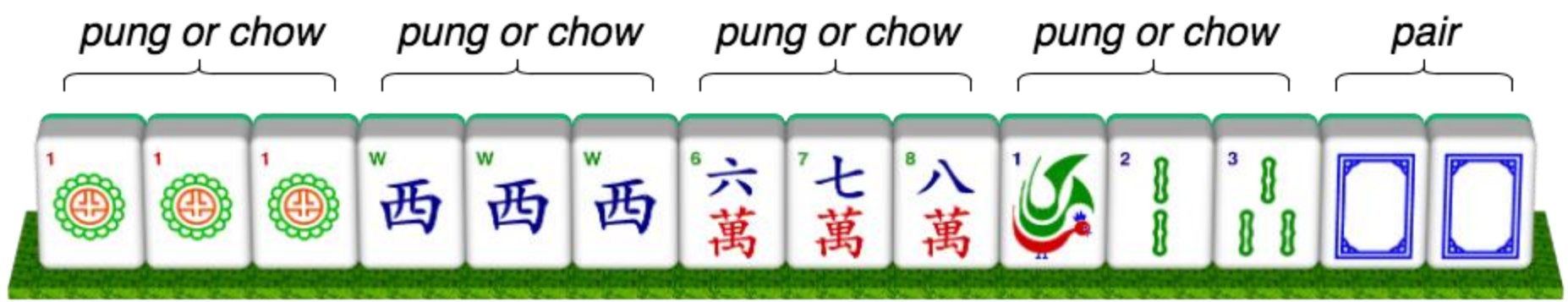
1	2	3	4
spring	*summer*	*autumn*	*winter*

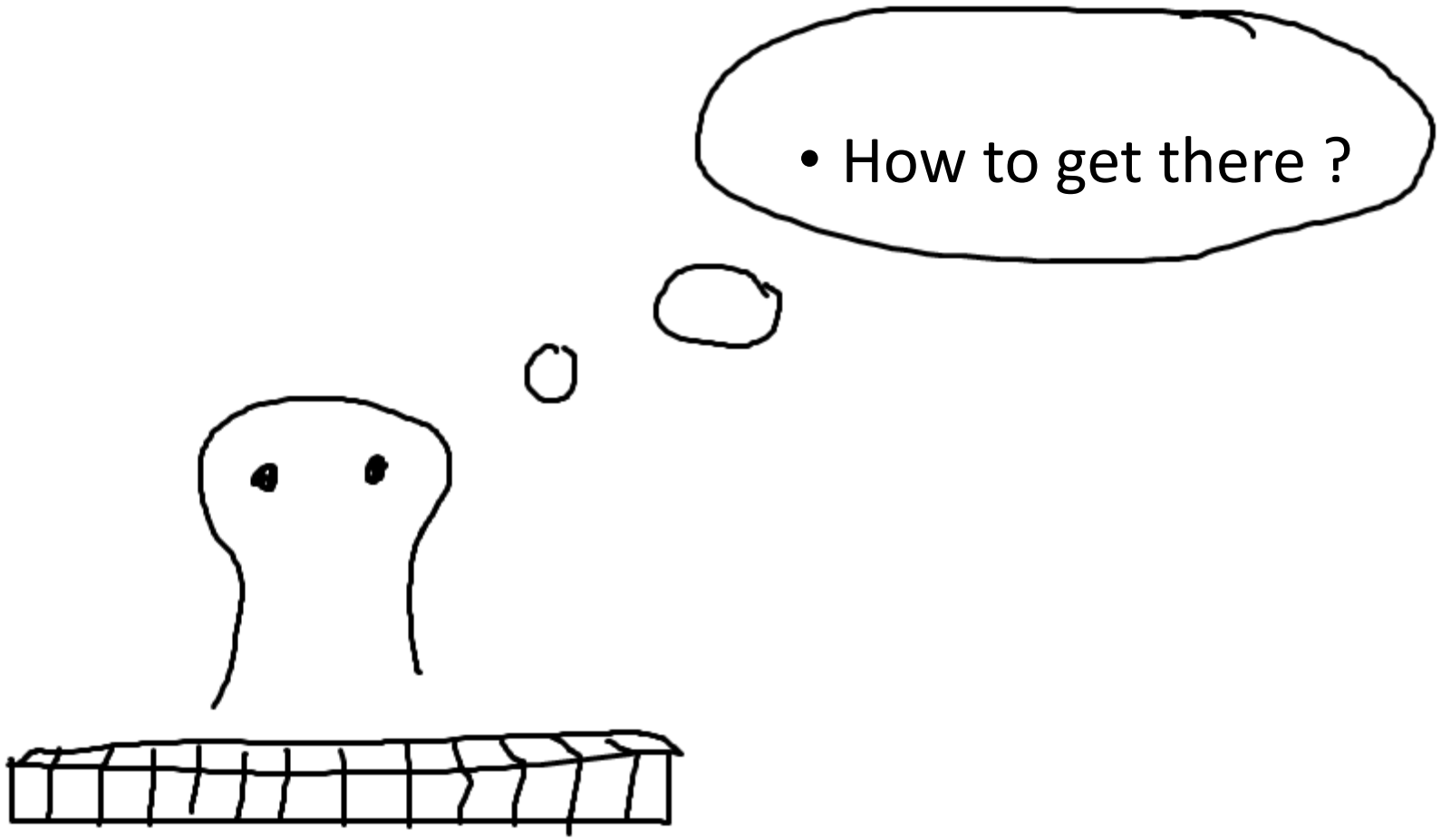

What can I do with the tiles?


3-tile sets
pung
中
中
中
3 x identical
chow
3
4
5
+1
+1
sequence of
3 x same suit


• What’s the goal?

winning hand = 4 x [pung or chow] + 1 x pair




• How to get there ?

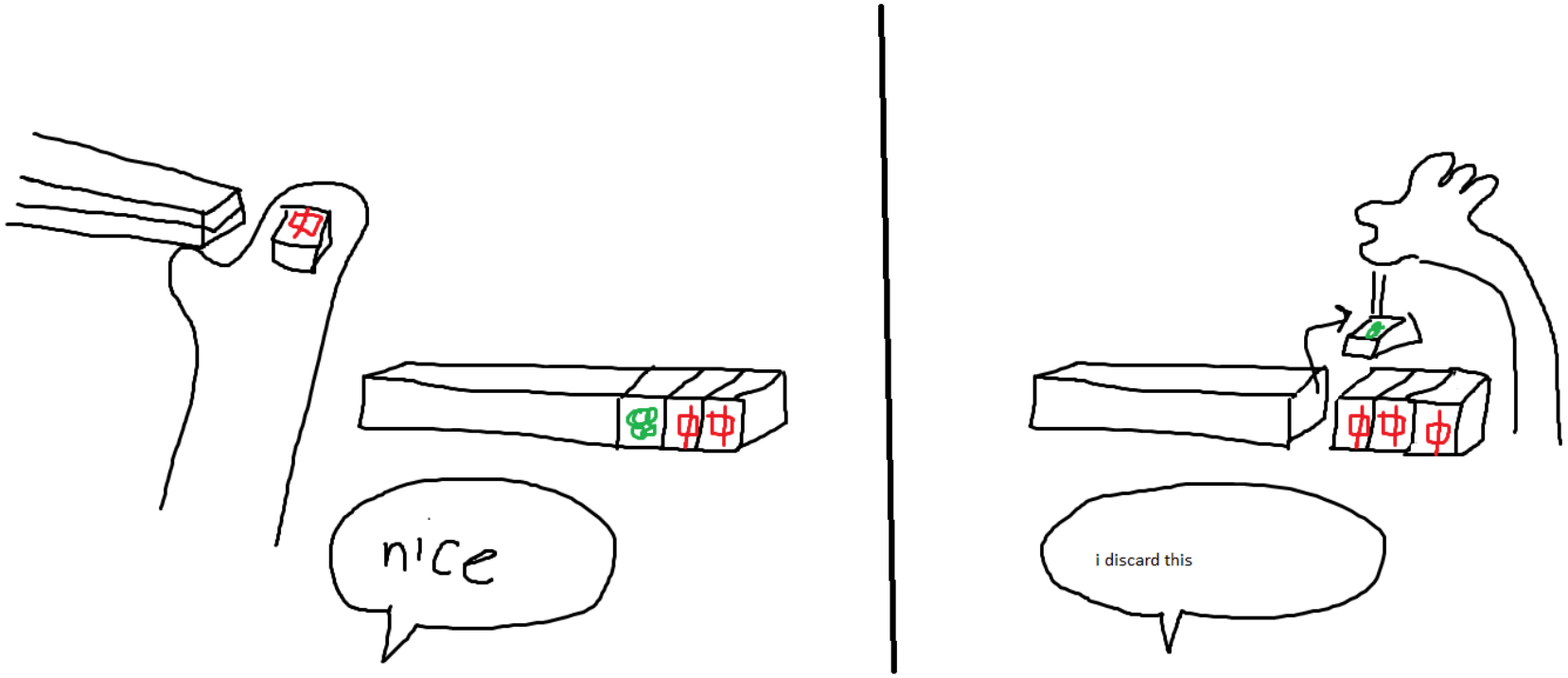
Typical turn

- Everyone should have 13 tiles by default

- Gain a tile (I'll explain how) -> 14 tiles
  - Either:
    - It's a winning hand! You win!
    - or:
    - Discard your worst tile -> back to 13 tiles

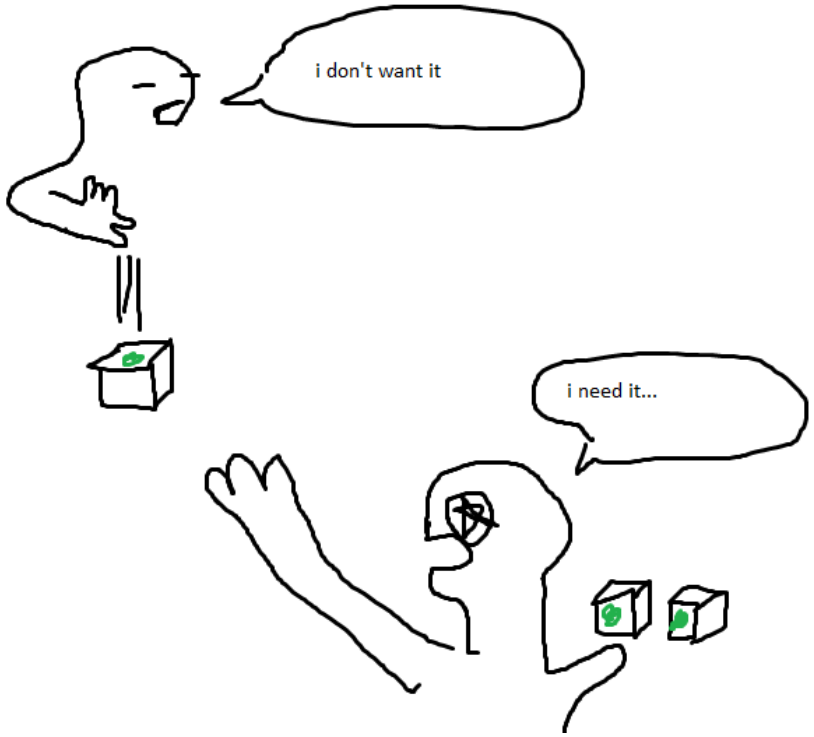
Gaining a tile: from the wall

- Typical turn: grab from the wall
- discard what you don’t like

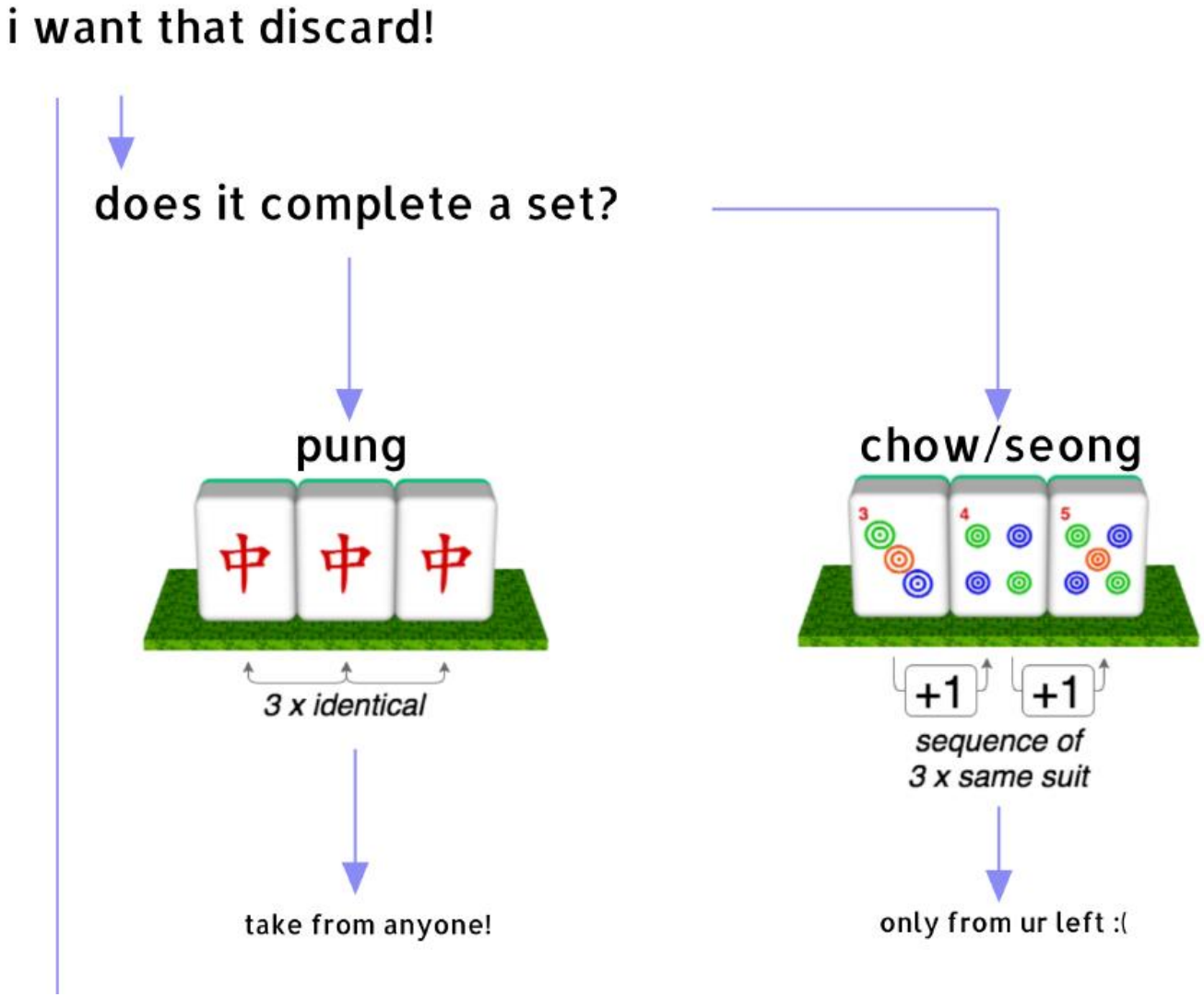


Gaining a tile: stealing a discard

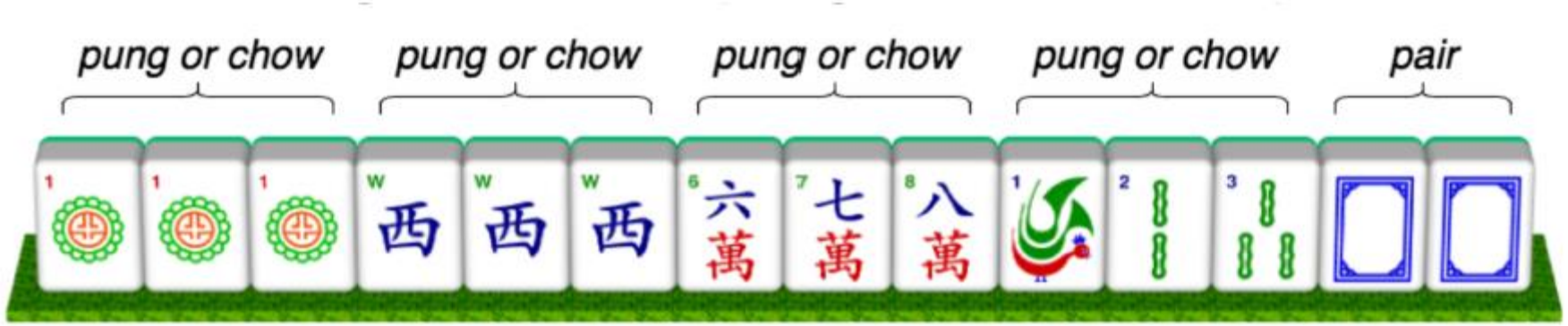
- The heart of mahjong : stealing



Gaining a tile: stealing a discard



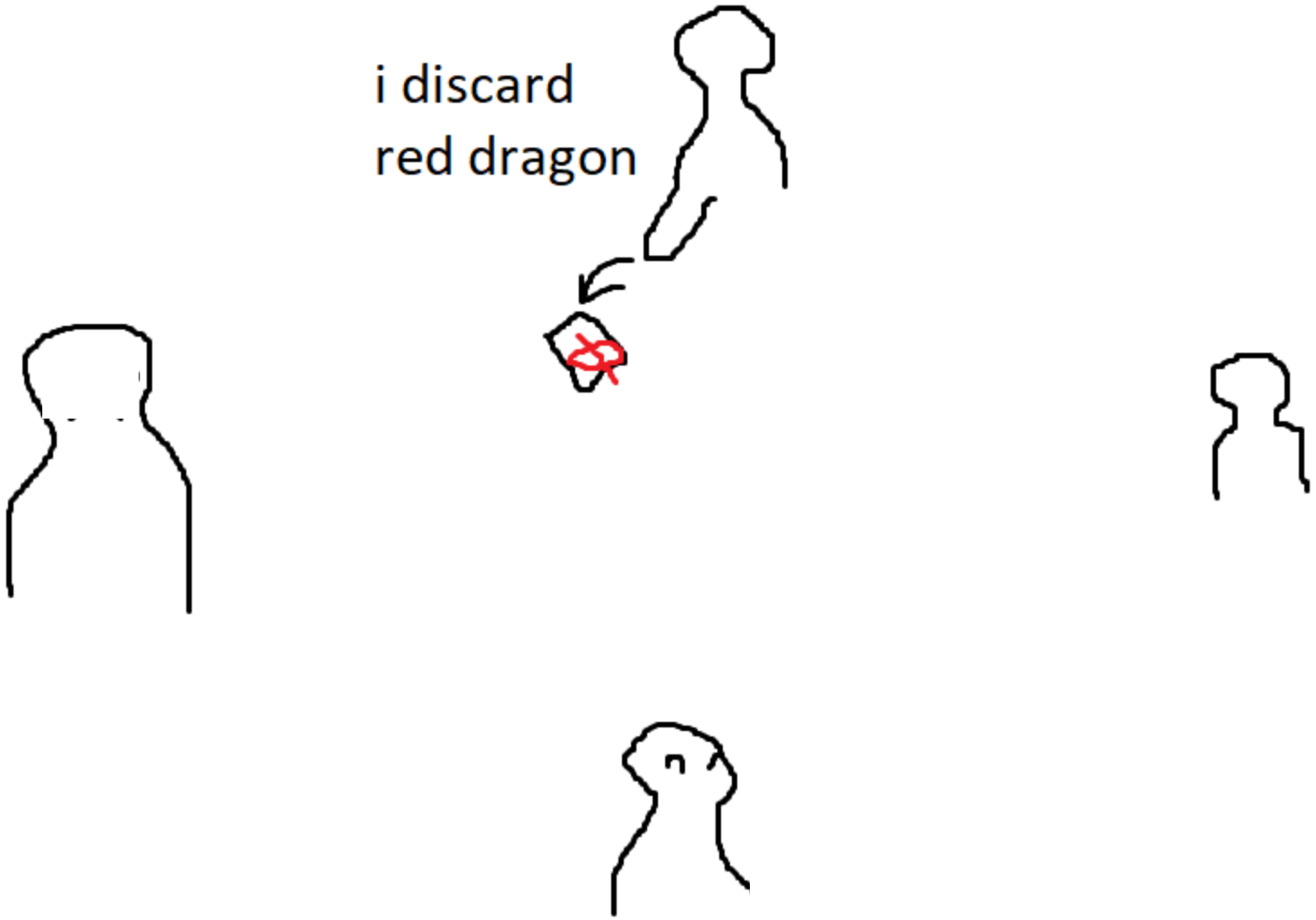
is it the final piece for your winning hand? take it!



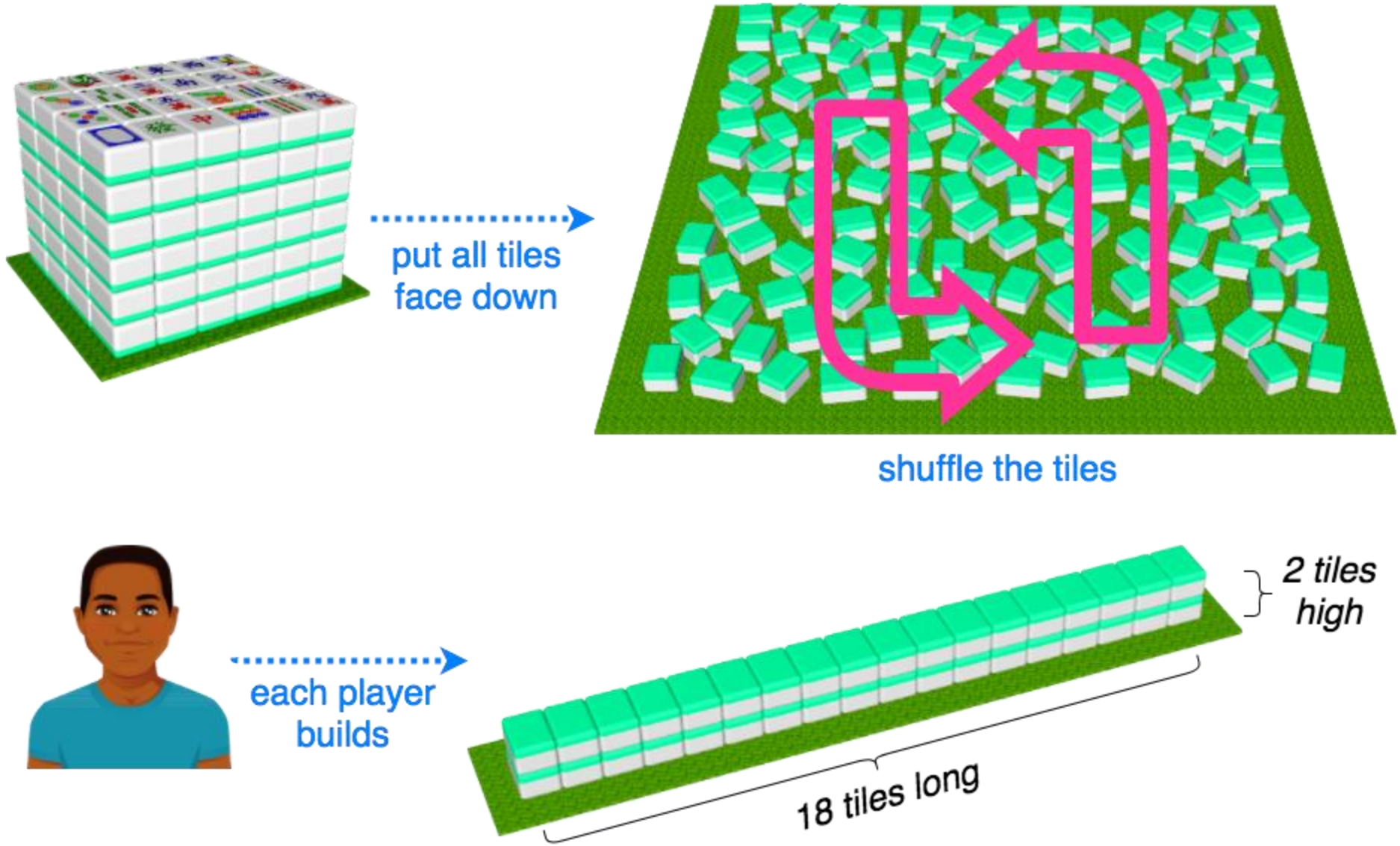
winning hand = 4 sets + 1 pair (eyes)

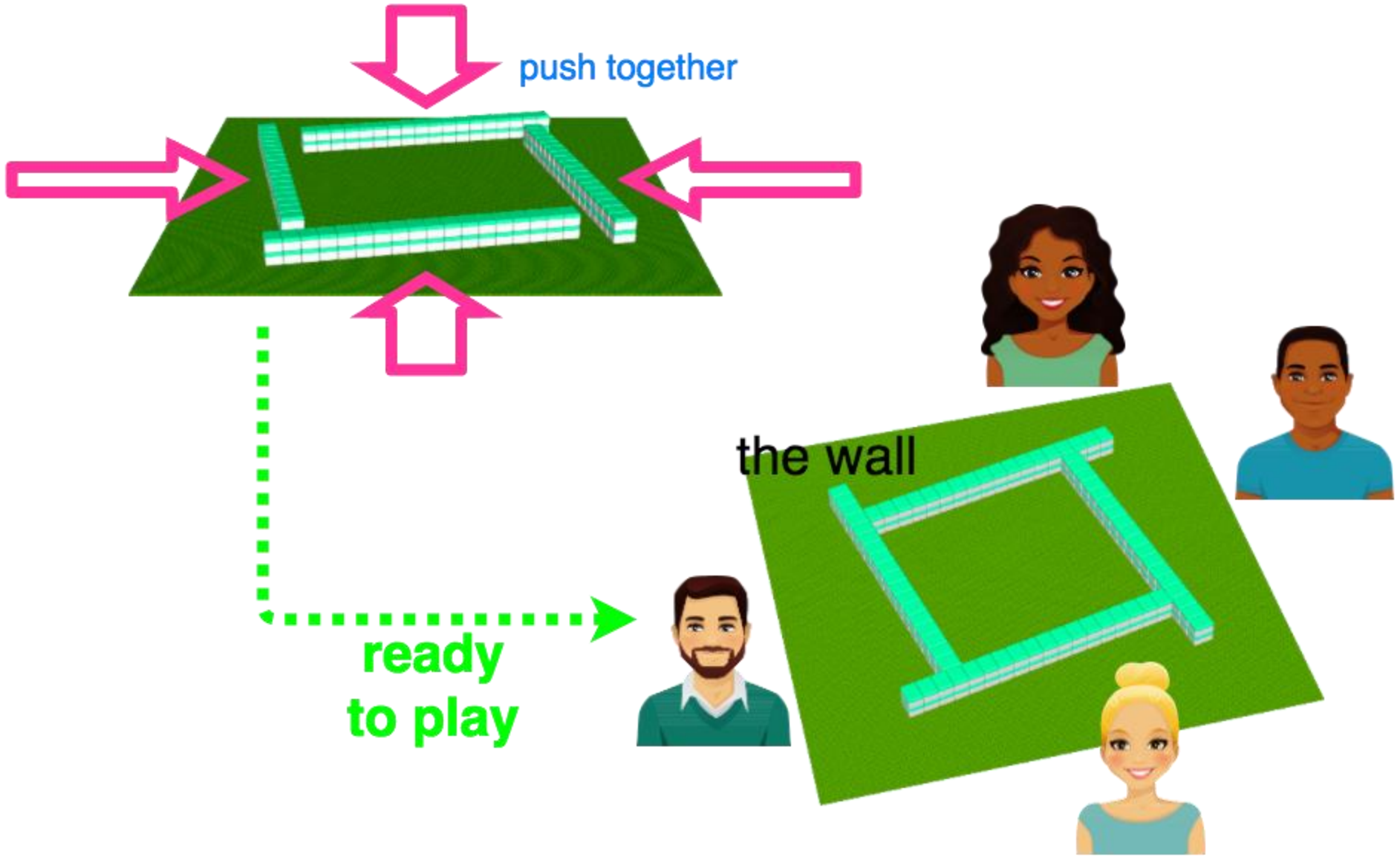
- Important:
- Pung (identical 3) can be from anyone, and
  - after Pung, you discard as if it was your turn, so
    - It can skip someone’s turn

eg



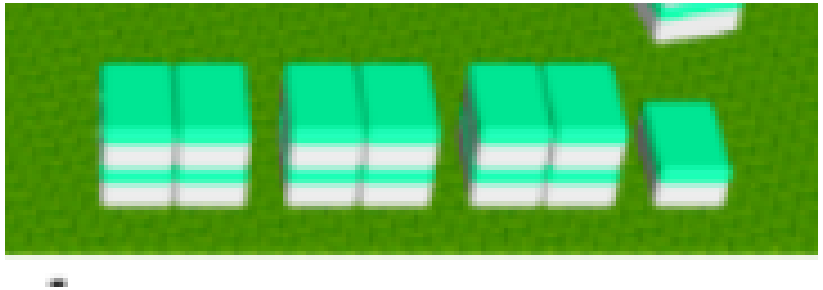
How to setup jong


put all tiles
face down
shuffle the tiles
each player
builds
2 tiles
high
18 tiles long


push together
ready
to play
the wall

Drawing your first hand

- Take turns taking 4 tiles
- 3 times: 4 , 4 , 4 = 12
- Final: take 1 tile
- Everyone should have **13 tiles**



- Dealer begins by taking an additional tile = 14 tiles

- Dealer begins the game by discarding

- Then, next player either steals that discard,
- Or, draws from the wall.
- Then, discards themselves.
- Continue this!

- Lets play !

Things to cover in play

- Flower/season tiles
- Pung/chow/mahjong precedence
- Kong: stolen, selfdraw, concealed, robbing
- Advanced points gameplay & Taiwan style hand